

BETAPRO CREAM 0.05%

DESCRIPTION:

A white smooth homogenous mass.

COMPOSITION:

Each gm of the cream contains Betamethasone dipropionate (Micronised) equivalent to 0.5 mg of Betamethasone.

ACTIONS & PHARMACOLOGY:

The overall actions of corticosteroids are catabolic. Corticosteroids diffuse across cell membranes and complex with specific cytoplasmic receptors. These complexes then enter the cell nucleus bind to DNA (chromatin) and stimulate transcription of messenger RNA (mRNA) and subsequent protein synthesis of various inhibitory enzymes responsible for anti-inflammatory effects of topical corticosteroids. The pharmacologic activity of topical corticosteroids is increased by several changes in molecular structure. Substitution or masking of 16 or 17 hydroxy groups with longer side chains such as acetone propionate or valerate increases lipophilicity and subsequently stratum corneum penetration.

Absorption: Absorbed systemically across the stratum corneum. Stratum corneum penetration is primarily enhanced by increasing skin hydration and or temperature, or by changes in molecular structure of the compound. Hydrating the skin with occlusive dressings such as plastic wrap, a tight-fitting diaper or one covered with plastic pants, plastic tape, or dermatological patches can increase corticosteroid penetration by up to ten-fold. Intertriginous areas and the face also have inherently thinner skin, are more macerated and therefore, allow for increased absorption. Absorption of topical corticosteroids has been greatly increased by altering the product vehicle. Vehicles containing substances that solubilize the corticosteroid enhance absorption. Increasing the concentration of drug increases skin penetration. Decreasing drug particle size has been shown to increase topical bioavailability. Increased percutaneous absorption of corticosteroids also occurs when the skin or mucosa is abraded or inflamed, when body temperature is elevated, with prolonged use, or with extensive use.

Biotransformation: Primarily skin; once absorbed systemically, in the liver. Betamethasone is resistant to local metabolism in the skin. Repeated application results in a cumulative depot effect in the skin, which may lead to a prolonged duration of action, increased side effects, and increased systemic absorption.

INDICATIONS:

Topical corticosteroids are indicated for the relief of the inflammatory and pruritic manifestations of corticosteroids responsive dermatoses.

DOSAGE & ADMINISTRATION:

Usual adult dose: Apply a thin film to the affected skin area one or two times a day.

Usual pediatric dose: Apply a thin film to the affected skin area once a day. Do not use in or around eye.

ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION

Topical Administration

CONTRAINDICATIONS:

Contraindicated in those who are allergic to steroids or any component of the preparation.

SIDE EFFECTS:

The incidence and severity of local or systemic side effects increase with factors that increase percutaneous absorption. Percutaneous absorption has resulted in systemic side effects such as hyperglycemia, glycosuria and hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal (HPA) axis suppression. Less frequent side effects are burning, itching, irritation, dryness, folliculitis, hypertrichosis, acneiform eruptions, hypopigmentation, perioral dermatitis, allergic contact dermatitis, maceration of the skin, secondary infection, skin atrophy, striae, and miliaria.

WARNING/PRECAUTIONS:

Topical corticosteroids especially the more potent ones should not be used extensively, in large amounts, or for protracted periods in pregnant patients or in patients who are planning to become pregnant. Children and adolescents have a large skin surface area to body weight ratio and less developed, thinner skin, which may result in absorption of greater amounts of topical corticosteroids compared with older patients. Absorption is also greater in premature infants than in full term newborns, due to inadequate development of the stratum corneum. Risk-benefit should be considered when the following medical problems exist. Infection at treatment site (may be exacerbated if no appropriate antimicrobial agent is used concurrently) skin atrophy, pre-existing (may be exacerbated due to atrophigenic properties of corticosteroids). Adrenal suppression, Cushing's syndrome, intracranial hypertension and growth retardation due to systemic absorption of topical corticosteroids have been documented in children. Therefore, special care must be exercised when these agents are used in children and growing adolescents, especially if factors that increase absorption are involved. The treated skin area should not be bandaged, or covered or wrapped as to be occlusive. Topical corticosteroids should be used with caution in patients with evidence of pre-existing skin atrophy. Blood and urine glucose concentration may be increased if significant absorption of the corticosteroid occurs. Gradual withdrawal of therapy by decreasing frequency of application may be necessary to avoid a rebound flare-up of certain conditions such as psoriasis. Tachyphylaxis may also result from continual usage. Do not use in children under 1 year of age.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION:

Since safety of the use of topical corticosteroids in pregnant women has not been established, drugs of this class should not be used on pregnant patients in large amounts or for prolonged periods of time.

Caution should be exercised when administered to nursing women.

EFFECTS ON ABILITY TO DRIVE AND USE MACHINE

None Known

INTERACTIONS WITH OTHER MEDICAMENTS

None Known

OVERDOSAGE & TREATMENT:

Symptoms: Symptoms of the adverse reactions.

Treatment: Since there is no specific antidote available, treatment is symptomatic, supportive and consists of discontinuance of topical corticosteroid therapy. If a local infection develops at the site of application, discontinue the therapy and institute appropriate antimicrobial therapy.

PRESENTATION:

Aluminium tubes 5g, 10g and 15g.

STORAGE CONDITIONS:

Store in a cool dry place below 30°C.

Keep containers tightly closed.

Protect from light and freezing.

Keep medicine out of reach of children.

For external use only.

MANUFACTURED BY:

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5 1/2 Mile off Jalan Meru,

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DATE OF REVISION:

June 2021